

GREEN PRACTICES IN THE CAFE INDUSTRY

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Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management

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ABSTRACT

This study examined the level of awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices among micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad, Benguet. It was initiated in response to growing environmental concerns in the hospitality industry and the lack of research focusing on the sustainable efforts of micro-scale hospitality industry. The study aimed to assess how cafe establishments understand, apply, and comply with environmentally responsible practices and to determine if a relationship exists between awareness and compliance. A descriptive quantitative approach through correlation design was employed, using validated survey questionnaires answered by 40 cafe employees. The data collected were treated using weighted mean, frequency, and percentage, and Spearman's Rank Correlation. The findings revealed that respondents were highly aware of water conservation, biodegradable packaging, and cost-saving benefits. Waste segregation and water-saving were the most implemented, while digital transactions, grease trap usage, and energy-efficient equipment had the lowest implementation. Respondant are also compliant to the green practices. They are highly Compliant to in water-saving measures, waste segregation, recyclable packaging, and lowest in digital tools, energy-efficiency, and policies on green practices. Spearman's Rank Correlation between awareness and compliance yielded a rho-value of 0.256 with a p-value of 0.111, indicating no that there is significant relationship since the p-value is greater than the standard significance level of 0.05. The findings suggested that a high level of awareness among micro-scale hospitality operators does not automatically result in full compliance with green practices. Although cafe staff recognize the value of environmental sustainability, actual compliance is often hindered by lack of funding, inadequate infrastructure, and limited technical support. Government units and

environmental should agencies provide more accessible training programs that focus on the practical implementation of green practices. Subsidies or incentives should be offered to encourage the adoption of energy-efficient technologies and environmentally friendly systems. In addition, public awareness campaigns will be strengthened to cultivate not only individual awareness but also collective responsibility within the business sector.

Keywords: *Green practices, level of awareness, level of compliance, implementation, micro-scale hospitality*

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

	Page
TITLE PAGE.....	i
Approval Sheet.....	ii
Abstract.....	iii
Acknowledgement.....	iv
Table of Contents.....	v
List of Tables.....	vi
List of Figures.....	vii
CHAPTERS	
1 INTRODUCTION	
Background of the Study.....	2
Theoretical/Conceptual Framework.....	6
Paradigm of the Study.....	12
Statement of the Problem and Hypothesis.....	16
2 METHODOLOGY	
Research Design.....	18
Population and Locale of the Study.....	18
Data Gathering Tool.....	19
Data Gathering Procedure.....	19
Treatment of Data.....	20
Ethical Considerations.....	22
3 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION	
Level of Awareness as to Green Practices.....	24
Green Practices being Implemented.....	33
Level of Compliance as to Green Practices.....	36

Correlation between Level of Awareness and Level of Compliance.....	41
4 CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS	
Conclusions.....	43
Recommendations.....	43
REFERENCES.....	45
APPENDICES	
Consent Forms.....	48
Letter to the Respondents.....	49
Survey Questionnaires.....	50
Face Validity and Reliability of Survey Questionnaires.....	52
Location Map of Central Cafes in La Trinidad.....	53
CURRICULUM VITAE.....	54

LIST OF TABLES

Table No.		Page
1	Frequency and Mean of the Level of Awareness as to Green Practices.....	25
2	Frequency and Percentage of the Green Practices being Implemented.....	35
3	Frequency and Mean of the Level of Compliance as to Green Practices.....	39
4	Correlation between Level of Awareness and Level of Compliance.....	44

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure No.		Page
1	Paradigm of the Study.....	13

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Background of the Study

Green practices are environmentally responsible actions undertaken by individuals or organizations to minimize harm to the environment. In the environment, In the hospitality industry, particularly among micro-scale businesses such as cafes, green practices focus on daily operational methods that promote environmental care. Green practices in the hospitality industry refer to eco-friendly actions and policies designed to minimize the environmental footprint of hotel and resort operations. These span multiple areas, including energy conservation, waste management, water conservation, and sustainable sourcing (Saikia,2024).

As sustainability becomes a global priority, cafe businesses must align with evolving environmental expectations to remain competitive. By incorporating innovative eco-friendly solutions, such as green certifications, alternative energy sources, and waste reduction techniques, businesses can contribute to a more sustainable future.

In energy conservation, implementing energy-efficient strategies such as LED lighting, occupancy sensors, and renewable energy solutions has been shown to improve operational efficiency and reduce carbon footprints. For instance, energy-efficient lighting systems such as LED lighting and occupancy sensors reduce electricity consumption, while water-saving technologies like low-flow showerheads and greywater recycling systems help conserve water resources (Saikia,2024). In addition, many hospitality establishments are adopting smart irrigation systems, linen reuse programs, and real-time water monitoring technologies to further reduce water consumption without compromising guest

comfort (Antonova, Ruiz-Rosa, & Mendoza-Jimenez, 2021; Lindhorn, 2024). Waste management strategies include composting, recycling, and reducing single-use plastics. In addition, circular economy principles such as using food waste for bio-energy are increasingly being adopted by café businesses worldwide to enhance sustainable efforts. Some businesses have adopted circular economy principles, such as using food waste to generate bio-energy or re-purposing waste materials. Sustainable sourcing practices are also gaining momentum, with hotels and restaurants prioritizing local and seasonal ingredients, supporting smallholder farmers, and reducing transportation-related emissions. This approach not only minimizes environmental impact but also enhances brand authenticity and strengthens community ties (Hospitality Business Review, 2024; Macro, 2024).

The café industry is a dynamic sector encompassing lodging, food and beverage services, event planning, and tourism-related activities (Cvent, 2023). It plays a crucial role in economic development, job creation, and cultural exchange, making sustainability an essential factor for long-term viability. In recent years, the industry has faced increasing pressure to adopt green practices, which refer to environmentally responsible actions undertaken by individuals or organizations to minimize harm to the environment. Studies show a strong correlation between the adoption of green practices and increased customer satisfaction and loyalty (Smith & Johnson, 2020). This positive perception translates into enhanced brand reputation and market competitiveness in an increasingly Eco-conscious market (Crespo & Rodríguez, 2020). Furthermore, green initiatives contribute to global environmental goals by reducing carbon footprints and resource consumption (Bugdol, Szromek, & Puciato, 2023). Despite the growing awareness of sustainability, many hospitality businesses, particularly micro-scale establishments

such as cafés face challenges in implementing green initiatives due to financial constraints, lack of knowledge, and inconsistent regulatory support (McCartney & Kwok, 2021). These limitations hinder widespread adoption, despite clear advantages such as customer loyalty, operational cost savings, and positive brand reputation (Mehta, 2020; Dael & Saab, 2023). Small hospitality businesses often struggle with high upfront costs of sustainable technologies and limited access to financing options that support environmental initiatives. Without proper funding structures, many operators are unable to transition to full sustainability. These initiatives are becoming increasingly important as customers become more environmentally conscious. In India, Mehta (2020) found that most respondents were not only aware of green hotel practices but were also more likely to revisit environmentally responsible establishments. Similarly, Dael & Saab (2023) noted that increased environmental awareness spurred by issues such as global warming and resource scarcity has motivated both policymakers and hospitality stakeholders to embrace green principles.

Global examples further emphasize the impact of these practices. In Sri Lanka, hotels have improved operational sustainability by composting, sourcing food locally, and replacing plastic amenities with biodegradable alternatives, which also enhanced guest satisfaction and community engagement (Herath, Tham, & Khatibi, 2023). Meanwhile, Australian hotels that embraced green certifications saw improvements in customer retention and operational efficiency (Khatter, White, & Pyke, 2021). These examples highlight that the benefits of green hospitality extend beyond environmental gains to include positive impacts on branding, customer loyalty, and cost savings. Previous studies have predominantly explored sustainability efforts in metropolitan areas.

However, research focusing on micro-scale businesses in rural or semi-urban areas remains scarce, leaving the specific challenges under examined thus creating a gap in literature that this study aims to address. Understanding how sustainability adapts to different business scales and geographic locations is crucial for creating industry-wide best practices.

While sustainability in hospitality has been widely studied, several critical gaps remain. First, most existing research focuses on large-scale hotels and resorts, leaving micro-scale businesses such as cafes and small restaurants underrepresented in sustainability discussions. These smaller establishments often lack the financial and operational capacity to implement large-scale green initiatives, yet they contribute significantly to local economies and environmental impact.

The implementation of green practices in the hospitality sector presents specific challenges. Waste management, particularly the high volume of disposables, necessitates innovative reduction, reuse, and recycling strategies. Water conservation requires efficient practices throughout operations. Cafes, in particular, have a unique opportunity to educate and engage customers, fostering environmental awareness through clear communication and promotion of responsible consumption (Dael & Saab, 2023). Successful implementation demands careful planning, staff training, and clear operational procedures, along with consistent monitoring for continuous improvement (Khatter, White, & Pyke, 2021).

In La Trinidad, Benguet, a region known for its agricultural richness, hospitality industries have begun embracing green initiatives such as reducing waste and minimizing energy consumption. Building on these local efforts, the Sangguniang Bayan of La Trinidad institutionalized waste-reduction requirements through *Municipal Ordinance No. 11-2015*, formally titled the “Plastic Bag,

Polystyrene and Other Synthetic Packaging Materials Reduction Ordinance of La Trinidad.” The measure prohibits business establishments including cafes, restaurants, and lodging houses from dispensing plastic carry-out bags or Styrofoam containers, and it mandates a shift to biodegradable or reusable packaging. Graduated fines of Php1,000, Php1,500, and Php2,500 are imposed on first to third offenses, respectively, with possible suspension of business permits for repeated non-compliance. Full enforcement began in January 2018 and was strengthened again in 2024 amid rising plastic use. By providing both a regulatory push and clear penalties, the ordinance creates an enabling environment that catalyzes the very green practices (e.g., waste segregation, alternative packaging) examined in this study, thereby aligning micro-scale hospitality operations with the municipality’s broader solid-waste-management agenda. These efforts contribute to environmental stewardship while also aligning with customer expectations and sustainability trends (Garcia & Santos, 2020).

Second, current literature tends to emphasize consumer preferences and attitudes toward green hospitality rather than the operational challenges faced by business owners. While understanding customer behavior is essential, there is limited research on the practical barriers that prevent small hospitality businesses from adopting sustainable practices, such as cost constraints, lack of supplier options, and inadequate government incentives. Addressing this gap requires a deeper examination of business strategies, financial limitations, and training initiatives that can support small-scale hospitality operators. Without tailored solutions, these businesses will continue facing roadblocks in sustainability adoption. Third, regional studies on sustainability in hospitality are scarce, particularly in semi-urban and rural areas like La Trinidad and Benguet.

Most research is concentrated in metropolitan areas, where businesses have greater access to resources and regulatory support. This study aims to bridge this gap by examining sustainability efforts in a local context, providing insights that can inform policymaking and industry best practices.

With these gaps from, the researchers aim to examine the level of awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices among hospitality businesses in La Trinidad, while exploring how these factors influence operations, customer satisfaction, and environmental outcomes. It aims to generate insights that address both the benefits and challenges of sustainable practices, offering valuable guidance for business owners, policymakers, consumers, and future researchers committed to advancing sustainability in the local hospitality sector.

The findings of this study will benefit multiple stakeholders. Hospitality business owners and managers will gain insights into effective green practices that can improve operations and brand image. Local government units and policymakers will be equipped with data to support environmental programs and regulations. Customers and the general public will benefit from improved service quality and environmental stewardship. Lastly, future researchers will find this study a valuable reference for expanding sustainability research in rural hospitality contexts.

Theoretical/Conceptual Framework

This framework is aligned with environmental theories as it emphasizes how individual beliefs, social influences, and perceived control will shape the intention to engage in green practices, which is guided by the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), Value-Belief-Norm, Green Human Resource Management Theory (Green HRM), Resourced-Based View (RBV), and Organizational Life Cycle (OLC).

According to Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020), the Theory of Planned Behavior suggests that attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control significantly influence an individual's intention to engage in a particular behavior. This theory is useful in understanding why some micro-scale hospitality industries choose to apply green practices. If staff and owners see these actions as beneficial, feel encouraged by others around them, and believe they can do it with the resources, then they are more likely to put them into practice.

In the context of hospitality, TPB has been widely applied to explain both consumer and managerial toward sustainability. Hettiarachchi (2020) found that hotel guests' intention to stay at green hotels was strongly predicted by their attitudes toward eco-friendly practices, the influence of peers, and their confidence in making sustainable choices. Similarly, hospitality managers' willingness to implement green practices is shaped by their belief in the benefits of sustainability, perceived support from stakeholders, and their perceived ability to overcome operational barriers.

For instance, Nimri, Patiar, Kensbock, and Jin (2020) applied the theory of Planned Behavior to examine what influences Australian consumers intention to stay at environmentally friendly hotels. Their findings revealed that perceived behavioral control and attitude were the strongest predictors of selecting green accommodations. This highlights that people confidence in their capacity to engage in green practices, along with their favorable views of eco-friendly behavior is crucial in encouraging environmentally responsible choices within the hospitality industry. More, TPB provides a valuable lens for understanding the gap between awareness and action, a key issue identified in this study. Even when hospitality operators are aware of green practices, their actual implementation depends on

whether they feel capable of executing them, perceive social support, and believe the outcomes are worthwhile. This makes TPB especially relevant for micro-scale businesses, where resource limitations and social norms play a significant role in shaping behavior (Meng, Lee, Chua, & Han, 2022).

To support the theory of planned behavior, Value-Belief-Norm (VBN) Theory by Jebarajakirthy (2024) emphasizes that environmental values and personal moral obligations are key drivers in shaping individuals' intentions to engage in green practices. When people believe that their behavior directly impacts the environment and that they have a responsibility to protect it, they often feel a duty to act in an eco-friendlier way.

In the context of the hospitality industry, VBN Theory helps explain how deeply held environmental values among business owners and staff influence their awareness of sustainability issues. This internalized sense of responsibility often translates into proactive efforts to implement green practices such as energy conservation, waste reduction, and eco-friendly sourcing. The theory suggests that when individuals believe their actions matter and align with their moral norms, they are more likely to comply with sustainability standards, even in the absence of external enforcement (Jebarajakirthy, 2024).

This framework is particularly relevant to the study's aim of assessing the level of awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices. VBN theory implies that higher awareness is rooted in strong environmental values that can lead to more consistent implementation of green practices. Furthermore, it supports the idea that there is a meaningful relationship between awareness and compliance: the more individuals believe in the moral importance of sustainability, the more likely they are to follow through with actual behavior. Thus, VBN theory not only explains

why green practices are adopted but also why they are sustained over time.

Building upon the previous discussion, the Green Human Resource Management Theory (GHRM) by Renwick (2022), he brings in the organizational side of things about how companies can support green behavior by training staff, hiring people with eco values or recognizing environmentally responsible actions. This means that businesses are not just relying on employees' personal motivation, but they are actively building a culture that supports green practices. This theory is highly applicable to the hospitality sector, where frontline staff decisions directly affect daily operations and resource usage.

GHRM supports the implementation of green practices by embedding environmental values into workplace culture raising awareness, improving compliance, and aligning individual behavior with organizational sustainability goals. In this study, GHRM contributes to understanding how internal policies can influence employee awareness and their level of participation in sustainability initiatives, which may positively impact both implementation and compliance rates. (Alreahi et al., 2023).

Moreover, GHRM provides a framework for analyzing the long-term impact of green practices on employee engagement and retention. By fostering a culture of environmental responsibility, organizations can enhance their reputation and attract talent that aligns with their sustainability goals. This perspective is particularly relevant in the hospitality industry, where customer-facing roles require a high level of commitment to eco-friendly practices. Additionally, GHRM highlights the importance of continuous training and development to ensure that employees are equipped with the knowledge and skills necessary to implement green initiatives effectively. (Alreahi, 2023).

Furthermore, to better understand the differences on how green practices are applied, the Resource-Based View (RBV) Theory by Barney (2021) explains how a business's size and available resources can affect its ability to go green. Smaller or newer businesses might struggle more because they have fewer resources, while larger or more established ones may find it easier to put green strategies in place.

In the hospitality industry, RBV emphasizes that firms with valuable, rare, inimitable, and organizationally embedded (VRIO) resources such as eco-certified technologies, skilled green staff, or strong environmental leadership are more likely to implement and sustain green practices effectively (Kruesi & Bazelmans, 2022). These resources enable businesses to go beyond surface-level compliance and embed sustainability into their core operations. For example, hotels with advanced energy management systems or staff trained in eco-friendly protocols are better positioned to reduce environmental impact while maintaining service quality. Such capabilities are not easily replicated, giving these businesses a long-term advantage in both environmental and market performance.

This theory supports the study's investigation into how resource availability influences both the level of implementation and compliance with green practices. It also helps explain why awareness alone may not lead to action without the necessary internal capabilities, even well-informed businesses may fall short in execution.

In this context, RBV provides a lens to examine disparities among micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad. While some may be highly aware of sustainability principles, their ability to act on that awareness depends on whether they possess the financial, human, and technological resources to do so. Thus, RBV not only clarifies the role of internal assets in driving green practices but also

reinforces the importance of capacity-building initiatives to support smaller enterprises in their sustainability journey

The Organizational Life Cycle (OLC) Theory by Lester, Parnell, and Carraher (2021) posits that organizations evolve through predictable stages, typically including startup, growth, maturity, and either renewal or decline. Each stage is characterized by distinct structural, strategic, and operational features that influence how businesses respond to internal and external challenges. In the context of sustainability, this theory suggests that a business's position in its life cycle can significantly affect its capacity and willingness to adopt green practices (Lester, D. L., Parnell, J. A 2021)

OLC theory suggests that businesses evolve through these stages with varying levels of resource availability and operational maturity, which in turn influence their sustainability strategies (McCoy, 2023). For instance, mature hospitality businesses may have more formalized systems and financial stability to support green initiatives, while startups often prioritize survival over environmental investment. These differences highlight how organizational structure and experience can shape both awareness of green practices and the degree of compliance.

This framework directly supports the study's aim of assessing the relationship between awareness and compliance with sustainability efforts. Businesses at different life cycle stages may exhibit unequal levels of readiness, capacity, and motivation to act on environmental goals. For example, an established hotel may have the resources and experience to fully adopt green practices, while a new cafe may face limitations despite awareness. Thus, OLC theory provides a strategic lens for understanding implementation variance in the hospitality.

Paradigm of the Study

Figure 1 presents the paradigm of the study which serves a visual framework to explain the logical flow of the research. It illustrates the relationship between the level of awareness on green practices (independent variable) and the level of compliance with green practices (dependent variable) among micro-scale café industries in La Trinidad. The study begins by identifying the green practices currently being implemented by these establishments. It then assesses the extent to which café owners and operators are aware of such practices. Following this, the level of compliance with these practices is measured to determine how well the cafés are adhering to environmentally friendly standards. Finally, the study explores whether a significant relationship exists between the level of awareness and the level of compliance. Through this process, the research aims to determine if increased awareness leads to higher compliance with green practices, thereby providing insights into how sustainability can be promoted more effectively within the local café industry.

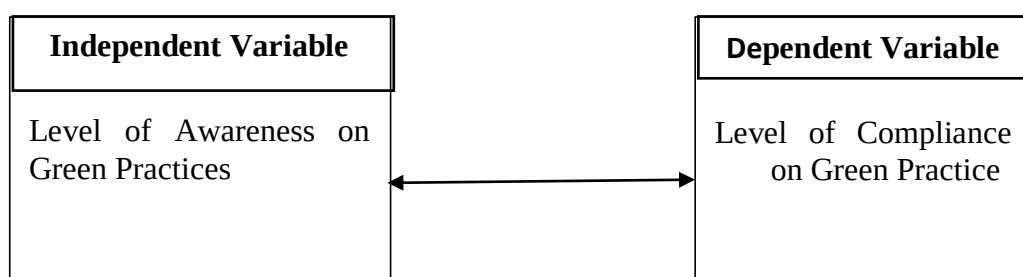


Figure 1: Paradigm of the Study

Awareness of Green Practices of Micro-Scale Cafe Industries

In the context of this study, it refers to the extent to which owners, managers, and staff of small-scale cafés in La Trinidad are knowledgeable about and understand environmentally sustainable practices relevant to their operations. This includes their familiarity with concepts such as water-saving measures and the use

of eco-friendly packaging materials that are widely recognized among café operators, likely due to their practicality and alignment with local environment policies. Awareness encompasses not only the recognition of these practices but also an understanding of their importance, benefits, and potential impact on both the environment and business sustainability. It is a key factor that may influence the willingness and ability of café operators to adopt and comply with green practices in their daily operations.

The development of environmental awareness among micro-scale café operators is shaped by a variety of external influences, particularly policies, economic factors, and exposure to global sustainability messaging. Local government initiatives, such as Municipal Ordinance No. 11-2015 in La Trinidad, reinforce environmentally conscious behavior by requiring businesses to shift away from single-use plastics. These kinds of legal frameworks help normalize green practices, making them a standard part of business operations and raising awareness through repeated exposure and enforcement.

At the national level, legislation like the Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) Act of 2022 plays a crucial role in encouraging all businesses regardless of size to be more conscious of their environmental impact. Programs launched by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR), such as the National Plan of Action for Marine Litter, recognize the importance of engaging even the smallest enterprises in addressing waste-related challenges. These initiatives contribute to a broader culture of sustainability and inform the knowledge base of small business owners.

Beyond national borders, international organizations like the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP, 2021) have emphasized the importance of

adopting eco-friendly materials and practices, especially in the hospitality and food sectors. These global perspectives often influence national policy and, in turn, filter down to micro-enterprises, helping shape their understanding of sustainability.

In addition to regulatory drivers, financial motivations also play a part. Reports from the International Trade Centre (2022) have shown that adopting environmentally friendly practices such as switching to biodegradable packaging can reduce costs and improve operational efficiency, which is particularly relevant for small businesses with limited resources. When business owners recognize both environmental and economic advantages, their awareness of sustainable practices tends to increase.

Theoretical models also help explain how awareness forms in small enterprises. The Theory of Planned Behavior (Yarimoglu & Gunay, 2020) posits that people are more likely to be informed and act on what they perceive as socially expected and realistically achievable. In this way, social pressure, perceived ease of implementation, and observed norms all contribute to the level of awareness. Likewise, the Resource-Based View (Barney, 2021) suggests that awareness is closely tied to the resources a business has such as access to training, environmental information, and decision-making support. Micro-enterprises with fewer resources may only develop awareness in areas they can afford to act on.

Together, these policy, economic, and theoretical influences show that awareness in micro-scale cafés is not simply a matter of personal knowledge, but a product of the systems, expectations, and capabilities that surround each business.

Compliance of Micro-Scale Café Industries with Green Practices

Compliance of micro-scale café industries with green practices, in the context of this study, refers to the degree to which small-scale café businesses in La

Trinidad implement and adhere to environmentally sustainable practices in their daily operations. This includes the actual application of measures such as proper waste segregation, energy-efficient equipment usage, water conservation methods, use of biodegradable or recyclable materials, and sourcing of local and sustainable products. Compliance reflects the extent to which these cafés align their operations with recognized green standards or guidelines, demonstrating their commitment to environmental responsibility. It serves as an indicator of how effectively their awareness of green practices is translated into concrete actions.

Compliance among micro-scale enterprises is shaped by a combination of internal motivation, resource capacity, and policy clarity. Various theories help explain the differing levels of adherence to green practices in small business settings.

For instance, the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) suggests that behavior is influenced by attitudes, perceived social norms, and an individual's sense of control over the behavior (Yarimoglu & Gunay, 2020). This means that even when café owners are environmentally aware and have a positive attitude toward sustainability, actual compliance depends heavily on whether they feel capable of implementing these practices within their limited resources and business context.

In this setting, some green practices particularly those seen as routine or socially expected are more easily implemented. This is where the Value-Belief-Norm (VBN) Theory becomes relevant. As explained by Jebarajakirthy (2024), individuals who hold strong pro-environmental values and believe their actions can make a difference are more likely to feel a moral obligation to act. This internalized sense of responsibility may drive compliance in areas like waste segregation or the use of biodegradable packaging, where the environmental and ethical dimensions are clearly visible.

However, compliance tends to decrease when a practice requires specialized equipment, technological upgrades, or operational restructuring. In these cases, the Resource-Based View (RBV) by Barney (2021) offers valuable insight. RBV argues that an organization's ability to execute strategic actions such as adopting energy-efficient appliances or transitioning to paperless systems depends on the availability of tangible and intangible resources. For micro-scale cafes with limited capital, technological access, or technical expertise, compliance with more complex sustainability measures becomes difficult, even when the environmental benefits are understood.

These perspectives highlight that compliance in micro-enterprises is not just a matter of willingness or knowledge but is closely linked to structural, financial, and regulatory support. When policies are unclear or difficult to enforce, or when resources are insufficient, even well-intentioned operators may struggle to implement sustainable practices consistently. Therefore, effective compliance strategies must consider not only education and regulation but also the provision of resources, technical support, and infrastructure to enable these businesses to meet sustainability standards meaningfully.

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to measure the awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices among cafe industries in La Trinidad and explore the relationship between awareness and the extent of implementation. Specifically, the study purposely addressed the following research questions:

1. What is the level of awareness of green practices of micro-scale cafe industries in La Trinidad?

2. What green practices are implemented by micro-scale café industries in La Trinidad?
3. What is the level of compliance of micro-scale café industries with green practices in La Trinidad?
4. Is there a significant relationship between the level of awareness and the level of compliance on green practices among micro-scale cafe industries in La Trinidad?

Null Hypothesis: There is no significant relationship between the level of awareness and level of compliance on green practices among micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter presented the research design, population, and locale of the study, and the data collection procedure.

Research Design

This study adopts a quantitative research design, which, according to Creswell and Creswell (2022), is “an approach for testing objective theories by examining the relationship among variables, which can be measured, typically on instruments, so that numbered data can be analyzed using statistical procedures.” Specifically, the study employs both descriptive and correlational research designs. A descriptive research design, as defined by Creswell (2014), seeks to “describe trends, attitudes, or opinions of a population by studying a sample of that population.” In this study, it is used to determine and present the current levels of awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices among micro-scale café industries in La Trinidad. In addition, a correlational research design is utilized to explore the statistical relationship between two or more variables without manipulating them. Creswell (2012) explains that correlational design “provides an opportunity to predict outcomes or test theoretical models relating variables.” This combined approach is appropriate for the study as it not only offers a detailed description of the extent to which green practices are known and implemented but also examines whether a significant relationship exists between awareness and compliance among café operators.

Population and Locale of the Study

The population of the study consisted of café owners operating micro-

enterprises that had been in business for a minimum of five years and were actively engaging in green practices, including waste segregation, the use of energy-efficient appliances, and the adoption of biodegradable materials. The researchers selected 20 cafes in La Trinidad using purposive sampling, focusing on centrally located establishments. A total of 40 respondents who met these criteria were invited to participate in the survey, which formed the basis for data analysis.

The study was conducted in La Trinidad, the capital municipality of Benguet, Philippines, widely recognized for its strawberry fields and categorized as a first-class municipality. It focused on micro small scale cafe establishments, specifically cafes operating within the area, with data collected from cafe staff as the respondents. Micro small-scale hospitality industries refer to small, independently owned businesses that operate with minimal resources and a limited number of personnel.

Data Gathering Tools

This study utilized a survey questionnaire as the primary data-gathering tool to collect information from cafe staff in La Trinidad. The survey questionnaire is divided into three parts, each addressing a key aspect of the research. Part 1 focuses on the respondents' level of awareness on green practices. Part 2 examines the green practices implemented in cafes. Part 3 evaluates the respondents' compliance with green practices. By using a validated questionnaire, this study ensures accurate data collection for analyzing sustainability efforts in La Trinidad's cafe industry.

Data Gathering Procedure

The data collection process began with the development of a structured questionnaire based on the main variables of the study. The questions were designed

to assess how aware and compliant cafe staff are with the green practices. Once the initial draft was completed, the questionnaire was submitted to the research adviser for review and feedback. To ensure that the questions are clear and relevant, the instrument underwent validity testing by the selected experts in the field. After receiving approval, the researchers identified cafes in La Trinidad that would serve as the focus for survey distribution. Formal letters were sent to the cafe owners or managers asking permission to distribute the survey to their staff. Once approval is granted, the researchers proceed to distribute the survey questionnaires. Depending on the availability and preference of the respondents, surveys were handed out either in printed form or shared online. Before the respondents fill out the form, they were first informed about the purpose of the study and assured that their responses would remain confidential and only used for academic purposes. It was also emphasized that their participation was voluntary. There is enough time given to the respondents to complete the questionnaire honestly and without pressure. Follow-ups were conducted when necessary to ensure that all targeted responses were gathered. After collecting the accomplished forms, each questionnaire was carefully reviewed for completeness and accuracy.

Treatment of Data

The collected data were tabulated for analysis. Frequency and percentage analysis were used to describe the level of awareness and level of compliance of cafe staff regarding green practices in the hospitality industry in La Trinidad. In addition, the mean was calculated to determine the average level of responses among participants. Awareness refers to the extent to which individuals involved in a study are informed, knowledgeable, or conscious about a particular topic, issue, or practice being investigated.

Percentage

$$\text{Formula: } \% = \frac{F}{N} \times 100$$

Where: % is Percentage

F is Frequency

N is Total Number of Respondents

100 is Constant Value

Mean

Formula:

$$\bar{X} = \frac{\sum X}{n}$$

Where:

$\sum X$ sum of all data values

n number of data items

After computing the frequency, the researchers used a 5-point Likert Scale with the following descriptions.

Range	Descriptive Equivalent	Description
4.50 - 5.00	Very Aware	Respondents are fully aware and highly knowledgeable.
3.50 - 4.49	Aware	Respondents are generally aware and informed.
2.50 - 3.49	Somewhat Aware	Respondents show partial awareness or are unsure.
1.50 - 2.49	Slightly Aware	Respondents lack sufficient awareness or understanding.
1.0 - 1.49	Not Aware at All	Respondents are unaware or not.

The level of awareness table is a tool used to interpret respondents' knowledge and understanding of green practices using a 5-point Likert scale. It categorizes average scores into descriptive levels- ranging from very aware to not aware at all- based on how well informed the respondents are. This helps researchers assess the extent of awareness among cafe staff regarding environmental practices in a clear and structured way.

Range	Descriptive Equivalent	Description
4.50 - 5.00	Very Compliant	Respondents consistently and strictly follow green practices.
3.50 - 4.49	Compliant	Respondents regularly comply with green practices.
2.50 - 3.49	Somewhat Compliant	Respondents comply occasionally or inconsistently.
1.50 - 2.49	Slightly Compliant	Respondents seldom comply with green practices.
1.0 - 1.49	Not Compliant at All	Respondents do not comply with green practices at all..

This table presents a compliance rating scale that measures the extent to which respondents follow green practices, using a 5- point Likert Scale ranging from 1.0 to 5.0. Each score range is assigned a descriptive label and a brief explanation of what that level of compliance means. It helps interpret survey results by categorizing respondents based on how consistently they apply environmentally friendly practices.

Spearman's Rank Correlation was utilized to determine the correlation between the level of awareness and the level of compliance on green practices among micro-scale industries in La Trinidad.

Formula:

Spearman's rank correlation

$$\rho = 1 - \frac{6 \sum di^2}{\pi(\pi^2 - 1)}$$

Where:

ρ is Spearman's rank correlation coefficient

di is difference between the two ranks of each observation

η is the number of observations.

Ethical Considerations

Before starting the study, the researchers made sure to follow proper ethical steps. First, they asked permission from the cafe owners or managers to allow their staff to join the survey. A formal letter was given to each business to explain the

purpose of the study and how the data would be used for academic purposes only.

After getting permission, the researchers explained the study to each participant. The respondents were told that their participation was voluntary, and they could refuse or stop at any time without any problem. They were also informed that their answers would be kept private and would not affect their job or business in any way.

Each participant was given a consent form to read and sign. This form explained the study in simple words, including their rights and how the information would be handled. Only those who fully understood and agreed were allowed to take part in the survey.

The survey questionnaire was designed to be clear and easy to answer. Participants were given enough time to answer the questions honestly without any pressure. The researchers made sure that no one was forced or rushed during the process.

Once all the surveys were collected, the researchers reviewed them carefully. No names or identifying information were written in the report to protect the privacy of everyone involved. The information was used only to help answer the research questions and will not be shared with anyone outside the study.

Lastly, the entire process from planning to data collection was guided by the rules set by their research adviser and the school. The researchers made sure that the study was done respectfully, honestly, and fairly for all participants.

CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents, discusses, and interprets the data collected from selected cafe staff in La Trinidad regarding their awareness, implementation, and compliance with green practices, structuring the presentation by research questions specified in the problem statement.

Table 1. Level Of Awareness as to Green Practices of Micro-Scale Café Industries In La Trinidad

No.	Statements	Mean	DE	Mean Rank
1.	Aware of green sustainable practices in the hospitality industry.	4.43	A	8
2.	Aware of the environmental impact of non-sustainable practices in hospitality industry	4.45	A	6.5
3.	Aware of energy-saving practices, such as using LED lights and energy-efficient appliances.	4.28	A	10
4.	Aware of water conservation methods, such as using low-flow faucets and reusing water when possible.	4.75	VA	1
5.	Aware of proper waste management practices, including recycling and composting.	4.60	VA	4.5
6.	Aware of the importance of reducing single-use plastics in hospitality industry operations.	4.38	A	9
7.	Aware of eco-friendly purchasing practices, such as sourcing from sustainable suppliers.	4.45	A	6.5
8.	Aware of alternative packaging materials that are biodegradable or recyclable.	4.65	VA	2.5
9.	Aware of government regulations and policies regarding sustainable hospitality practices.	4.60	VA	4.5
10.	Aware of how green practices contribute to cost savings- efficiency in a cafe setting.	4.65	VA	2.5
Overall Average Weighted Mean		4.52	VA	
Statistical Limit: DE/Descriptive Equivalent 4.50 to 5.00: Very Aware (extensive knowledge of this practice and its benefits)/VA 3.50 to 4.49: Aware (good understanding of this practice and its importance)/A 2.50 to 3.49: Somewhat Aware (some understanding of this practice but lack detailed knowledge)/SA 1.50 to 2.49: Slightly Aware (heard of this practice but do not fully understand it)/SA to 1.49: Not Aware at All (knowledge of this practice)/NA				

Table 1 presents the level of awareness of micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad. The computed overall average weighted mean is 4.52, which corresponds to a very high level of awareness. This result suggests that on average, the respondents are very aware of the green practices being measured. The researchers focused on the top three statements with the highest mean scores, indicating the strongest awareness, and the three lowest-ranked statements, which highlight potential areas for improvement.

The statement that ranked first is *"Aware of water conservation methods, such as using low-flow faucets and reusing water, when possible,"* with a mean of 4.75. This ranked first because water is a critical resource in daily cafe operations, especially for cooking, cleaning, and sanitation. Cafe staff in La Trinidad are likely to prioritize water-saving practices because of their practicality and visibility in the workplace. The strong awareness may also be influenced by the local context. La Trinidad is an agricultural area where people are generally more mindful of water use, especially during dry seasons. Additionally, many cafes already apply simple, low-cost water-saving methods, which helps reinforce their knowledge and habits related to conservation. The high score shows that among all green practices, water conservation is the most understood, recognized, and possibly already practiced by the respondents. It suggests that micro-scale hospitality operators in La Trinidad recognize the importance of conserving water and are likely already applying such practices in their daily operations. Water conservation is clearly a well-integrated and prioritized green initiative within these businesses. This high level of awareness reflects both environmental responsibility and practical business

sense, particularly as water is a crucial resource in hospitality operations such as cleaning, food preparation, and sanitation.

According to the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) proposed by Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020), an individual's behavior is influenced by their attitude toward the action, the social norms surrounding it, and their perceived ability to carry it out. Applying this to the findings, cafe staff may view water conservation as beneficial, feel supported by peers or policies that promote sustainability, and believe they have the means to adopt such practices effectively. These conditions strengthen the likelihood of awareness and consistent application. Therefore, TPB helps explain why water-saving practices received the highest awareness rating. It is a behavior reinforced by internal motivation, community expectations, and a sense of personal capability.

Second highest in rank are "*Aware of alternative packaging materials that are biodegradable or recyclable*", and "*Aware of how green practices contribute to cost-saving efficiency in a cafe setting*", which are tied with a mean of 4.65. Awareness of eco-friendly packaging is very high, indicating that respondents are conscious of reducing plastic waste and are familiar with sustainable alternatives. This reflects a proactive mindset toward minimizing environmental impact through responsible sourcing and packaging. Moreover, respondents understand the financial and operational benefits of sustainable practices. They are not only environmentally conscious but also recognize that green strategies can lead to economic advantages, such as reduced utility costs and improved efficiency.

This high level of awareness aligns with broader global efforts to combat environmental degradation linked to single-use plastics. According to the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP, 2021), sustainable packaging is now

considered a key strategy in reducing the environmental footprint of the hospitality and food sectors, which are among the highest contributors to plastic pollution. UNEP highlights that biodegradable and recyclable alternatives such as those made from bamboo, cornstarch, or recycled paper can significantly reduce waste and foster sustainable consumption patterns. This international call to action has shaped national policies and local behavior.

The Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) has issued various memoranda supporting the adoption of biodegradable and compostable packaging. The National Plan of Action for the prevention, Reduction, and Management of Marine Litter (DENR, 2021) underscores the role of local businesses, including micro-enterprises, in transitioning to sustainable packaging to prevent land-based sources of marine pollution. Moreover, Republic Act No. 11898, or the Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) Act of 2022, mandates manufacturers and business operators to manage the life-cycle of their plastic waste, thereby increasing demand and awareness of eco-friendly packaging across all business scales.

In the municipality of La Trinidad the local government unit enforces Municipal Ordinance No. 11-2015, which prohibits the use of plastic and Styrofoam in business establishments and actively promotes the use of eco-bags, paper-based packaging, and biodegradable utensils. This ordinance has not only influenced the purchasing behavior of hospitality businesses but also improved the environmental literacy of operators. A 2023 report by Benguet News confirmed that compliance rates among cafes and eateries in the area have significantly improved over the past five years, driven by customer preferences and increased inspections by local authorities.

Moreover, respondents understand the financial and operational benefits of sustainable practices. They are not only environmentally conscious but also recognize that green strategies can lead to economic advantages, such as reduced utility costs and improved efficiency. These insights are corroborated by the International Trade Centre (ITC, 2022), which emphasizes that small hospitality businesses adopting sustainable packaging often experience cost savings through bulk purchasing of reusable containers and reduced waste disposal fees. Similarly, Cruz and Ramos (2023) found that 78% of micro-enterprise operators in Northern Luzon reported positive financial impacts after switching to eco-friendly packaging, citing reduced packaging costs and increased customer patronage.

The high level of awareness of biodegradable and recyclable packaging among micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad not only illustrates a tangible commitment to environmental responsibility but also reflects a broader alignment with international sustainability goals, national policies, and local regulatory efforts. This elevated awareness level suggests that Eco-conscious packaging is not merely a compliance issue, but an integrated part of business strategy among local operators. According to the theory of Planned Behavior (TPB), behavior is influenced by an individual's attitude toward the social pressure they perceive and their ability to perform the behavior.

Lastly, *"Aware of proper waste management and aware of government regulations and policies"*, both tied with a mean score of 4.60. This shows that the respondents are highly aware of both proper waste management practices and government regulations related to environmental sustainability. This indicates that these aspects are well understood and recognized by the cafe staff in La Trinidad. Khatter, White, and Pyke (2021) emphasized that energy-efficient appliances, smart

lighting systems, and insulation upgrades in small hospitality businesses can result in significant cost reductions, often providing return on investment (ROI) within two to five years. This aligns with the respondents' perception that green practices enhance operational efficiency and reduce long-term overhead costs.

Moreover, Herath, Tham, and Khatibi (2023) found that micro-hotels and cafes in Sri Lanka that integrated green technologies such as solar-powered water heating, low-consumption lighting, and water-saving fixtures saw a noticeable improvement in cost control and customer satisfaction. These findings suggest that awareness of cost-saving mechanisms through sustainable practices is not limited to large enterprises but is being recognized and implemented even at the micro-enterprise level.

For instance, Garcia and Santos (2020) documented that several cafes and small lodging facilities in Benguet have begun implementing eco-friendly practices not just for compliance, but to cut operational costs. Examples include the installation of low-flow water systems, LED lighting, natural ventilation designs, and the use of locally sourced materials. These initiatives resulted in both financial savings and increased customer interest, particularly from environmentally aware tourists and students.

This data from La Trinidad suggests that respondents are highly aware of how sustainability translates into economic efficiency. This reflects dual awareness, one that balances environmental stewardship with practical business benefits. The presence of such awareness among micro-scale operators is a positive indicator of a mindset shift from sustainability as a moral obligation to sustainability as a smart business model.

However, while there is strong recognition of the specific economic benefits of

sustainability, the data also reveals gaps in broader conceptual understanding. This contrast highlights a critical insight: although operators may adopt sustainable practices that directly reduce operational costs, they may not fully grasp the overarching framework or long-term strategic value of sustainability in hospitality. This discrepancy becomes evident when examining the lower-ranked indicators of awareness.

While most respondents displayed a high level of awareness across most green practices, it is also crucial to highlight the three practices that received the lowest mean scores in the survey. These include awareness of energy-saving practices such as the use of LED lights and energy-efficient appliances (mean = 4.28); awareness of the importance of reducing single-use plastics in hospitality operations (mean = 4.38); and awareness of eco-friendly purchasing practices, such as sourcing from sustainable suppliers (mean = 4.45). Although these scores still fall within the “aware” category, they are noticeably lower than other items in the awareness scale.

The lowest-rated item is awareness of energy-saving practices, which includes knowledge of LED lighting and energy-efficient appliances, with a mean score of 4.28. Despite being categorized as “aware,” this score suggests that this area is relatively under emphasized. Many cafe owners may find it difficult to invest in energy-saving technologies due to financial limitations or lack of access to reliable suppliers. Additionally, such practices might not be seen as urgent compared to more immediate operational needs.

According to the Resource-Based View (RBV) Theory by Barney (2021), organizations are only able to adopt strategic environmental practices if they possess adequate resources. For micro-scale hospitality businesses, restricted capital and lack of access to affordable green technology could be major barriers,

leading to a lower level of awareness regarding energy-efficient tools and practices.

The second lowest is the importance of reducing single-use plastics, which received a mean score of 4.38. Although still relatively high, this figure indicates that respondents are less engaged with plastic reduction initiatives compared to other green efforts. The continued use of disposable plastics in cafes may be driven by cost-effectiveness and convenience. Shifting to biodegradable or reusable alternatives may present logistical and financial challenges, especially for small enterprises operating with tight budgets.

This is supported by the Organizational Life Cycle (OLC) Theory by Lester, Parnell, and Carraher (2021), which explains that businesses in their early or growth stages often lack the structural capacity or resources to invest in sustainable materials. As a result, practices like plastic reduction may be postponed or implemented only minimally despite basic awareness.

Many cafes in La Trinidad are micro or home-based enterprises, often run by families or individuals with limited capital. This business model contributes to the slow transition toward sustainable packaging alternatives. Although owners may be aware of the environmental consequences, they often face constraints such as the high cost of eco-friendly packaging materials and consumer price sensitivity which will hinder them from participating in green initiatives.

According to Campos (2025), micro and small enterprises in the Philippines encounter financial challenges in adopting sustainable packaging, particularly when such materials are more expensive and harder to source locally. Furthermore, research by Billion Bricks (2024) highlights that green alternatives, while increasingly in demand, are often unavailable in small volumes suitable for micro-businesses. Similarly, the Philippine Star (2022) reports that many consumers are

still reluctant to pay extra for Eco-packaged products, which discourages small hospitality operators from making the switch. These structural and market-related barriers collectively hinder the full implementation of sustainable packaging practices, even among those who are environmentally aware.

Mehta (2020) emphasized that while consumers prefer plastic-free options, cost and lack of government subsidies prevent smaller hospitality players from adopting eco-friendly materials. Bugdol, Szromek, and Puciato (2023) also observed that SMEs struggle to eliminate plastic due to a lack of regulatory enforcement and weak supply chains.

Lastly, is awareness of green sustainable practices with a mean score of 4.43. Although the score is still within the upper awareness category, it reveals that this concept may not be as familiar or prioritized among cafe staff. This could be due to a lack of information about sustainable sourcing options or limited availability of certified green suppliers in the area. It is also possible that businesses prioritize affordability over ethical sourcing when selecting vendors.

According to the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) by Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020), perceived control plays a vital role in shaping behavior. If cafe operators are uncertain about where to source sustainable goods or believe that such choices are beyond their financial means, they may not actively seek them out leading to a lower level of awareness in this area.

Khatter, White, and Pyke (2021) emphasized that despite the clear long-term savings from adopting energy-efficient systems, many small businesses delay implementation due to high initial costs or lack of technical knowledge. Also, Saikia (2024), pointed out that awareness of energy conservation is growing, but without targeted training or support programs, adoption remains inconsistent.

Table 2. Green Practices are Being Implemented by Micro-scale Cafe Industries.

No	Statements	Frequency	Percentage	Rank
1.	We use LED lights and energy-efficient appliances to reduce electricity consumption.	24	6.92	9
2.	We implement water-saving measures, such as low-flow faucets and water reuse systems.	40	11.53	1.5
3.	We properly segregate waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable materials.	40	11.53	1
4.	We have a recycling program for plastic, paper, glass, or other reusable materials.	34	9.80	5.5
5.	We minimize the use of single-use plastics by offering reusable or biodegradable alternatives.	34	9.80	5
6.	We use biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and deliveries.	36	10.37	3.5
7.	We promote paperless transactions by using digital receipts or QR code menus.	16	4.61	10
8.	We use eco-friendly cleaning products that are non-toxic and biodegradable.	36	10.37	3
9.	We follow policies regarding green practices.	31	8.93	7
10	We have installed a grease trap before operating the business.	25	7.20	8

The data presented in Table 2 illustrates the extent to which micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad are embracing green practices as part of their operational strategies. These practices reflect the industry's growing recognition of environmental sustainability as a core component of business ethics and customer appeal. By analyzing the frequency and percentage of implementation, it became evident that while some green practices are well-integrated, others lag, potentially due to infrastructural or economic barriers.

Based on the frequency and percentage data, the top-most implemented green practices among micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad are centered on water conservation and waste management. The highest-ranking practices, both

with a frequency of 40 (11.53%), are implementing water-saving measures, such as low-flow faucets and water reuse systems, and properly segregating waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable materials. These findings align with broader international trends highlighted by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP, 2022), which emphasized water conservation and waste reduction as foundational elements of sustainable tourism. In the national context, the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR), (2021) has promoted similar strategies through the “*Green Hotels*” campaign, which encourages small and medium enterprises (SMEs) to adopt basic yet impactful environmental practices, such as waste segregation and water reuse. Locally, a study by Dacumos and Cabato (2023) on eco-tourism in Benguet revealed that businesses in La Trinidad have increased efforts in sustainable waste management, primarily due to stronger municipal regulations and growing environmental awareness among operators.

Following closely behind, with a frequency of 36 (10.37%), are the practices of using biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and deliveries and using eco-friendly cleaning products that are non-toxic and biodegradable. These indicate a growing commitment to minimizing environmental impact across various aspects of business operations, including customer service and sanitation. According to the World Tourism Organization (UNWTO, 2023), the hospitality sector's adoption of green packaging solutions has steadily increased globally due to consumer demand for environmentally responsible brands. Nationally, the Eco Waste Coalition (2022) highlighted a shift among Filipino small and medium enterprises (SMEs) toward biodegradable packaging as a response to single-use plastic bans enforced in various Local Government Units (LGUs). Meanwhile, a local initiative led by the La

Trinidad Municipal Environmental and Natural Resources Office (MENRO, 2024) reported a 20% rise in the use of natural cleaning agents among registered food and hospitality establishments, attributing the change to recent awareness seminars and incentives offered for Eco-compliant businesses.

In contrast, there are least implemented green practices. One is promoting paperless transactions such as using digital receipts or QR code menus with only 4.61% reporting its adoption. This low figure may reflect limited access to digital tools or low customer readiness for digital alternatives. According to Nguyen and Tran (2019), many businesses, particularly small enterprises, face challenges in adopting digital systems due to cost and technological barriers. Similarly, Garcia and Lopez (2021) emphasized that in areas with poor internet connectivity or low digital literacy, businesses are less likely to implement technology-based green solutions.

Another low-ranking practice is the installation of grease traps, with only 25 establishments (7.20%) reporting implementation. Similarly, only 24 respondents (6.92%) reported using LED lights and energy-efficient appliances, despite the known cost and energy benefits. According to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (PIDS), (2021), digital transformation among micro-enterprises remains slow, primarily due to cost barriers and limited digital literacy. On the global scale, the International Telecommunication Union (ITU), (2022) emphasized that while paperless systems improve sustainability, implementation among small hospitality enterprises in developing countries is uneven due to infrastructural constraints. Another low-ranking practice is the installation of grease traps, with only 25 establishments (7.20%) reporting implementation, despite national mandates under the Clean Water Act. Similarly, only 24 respondents

(6.92%) reported using LED lights and energy-efficient appliances, despite the known cost and energy benefits. According to the Department of Energy (DOE), (2023), although energy-efficient systems can significantly reduce operational costs, initial investment costs deter smaller enterprises from adopting them. Locally, Cating-Cating and Orillos (2024) noted that only a fraction of micro-businesses in La Trinidad had shifted to energy-saving appliances, citing limited access to financing and awareness.

In summary, the data in Table 2 reveals that the most widely implemented green practices among La Trinidad's micro-scale hospitality industries are focused on water conservation and waste management, followed by packaging and cleaning innovations. However, the adoption of digital sustainability practices and energy-efficient technologies remains limited. These findings highlight the need for enhanced policy support, financial incentives, and educational outreach to bridge the gap between environmental awareness and practical implementation, ultimately fostering a more sustainable hospitality industry in the municipality.

Table 3. Level of Compliance of Micro-scale Cafe Industries as to Green Practices in La Trinidad.

No	Statements	Mean	DE	Mean Rank
1.	We use LED lighting and energy-efficient appliances.	3.80	C	9
2.	We implement water-saving measures, such as low-flow faucets and water reuse systems.	4.90	VC	1
3.	We properly segregate waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable materials.	4.68	VC	2
4.	We have a recycling program for plastic, paper, glass, or other reusable materials.	4.58	VC	4
5.	We minimize the use of single-use plastics by offering reusable or biodegradable alternatives.	4.13	C	6
6.	We use biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and deliveries.	4.60	VC	3

7.	We promote paperless transactions by using digital receipts or QR code menus.	3.53	C	10
8.	We have a recycling program for plastics, paper, glass, or other reusable materials.	4.18	C	5
9.	We follow policies regarding green practices.	4.05	C	8
10.	We have installed a grease trap before operating the business.	4.13	C	6.5
Overall Average Weighted Mean		4.26	C	
Legend: Statistical Limit: Descriptive Equivalent (DE) 4.50 to 5.00: Very Compliant (strictly followed at all times in our cafe.)/VC 3.50 to 4.49: Compliant (actively followed and implemented in our cafe.)/C 2.50 to 3.49: Somewhat Compliant (sometimes followed but not fully implemented.)/SC 1.50 to 2.49: Slightly Compliant (followed in a limited or inconsistent manner)/SC 1.0 to 1.49: Not Compliant at All (not followed in our cafe)/NC				

The data in Table 3 presents the level of compliance of micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad regarding the implementation of green practices. The computed overall average weighted mean is 4.26, which indicates that respondents are compliant. This result suggests that, on average, the respondents are consistently applying various environmentally green practices in their operations. This part of the study provides insight not only into which sustainable efforts are most frequently adopted but also how consistently they are practiced in daily operations. Understanding these levels of compliance is essential for identifying both the strengths and gaps in the sustainability behavior of small-scale hospitality operators. The varying degrees of compliance highlight how environmental awareness, access to resources, and external support influence green initiatives within this sector.

The practice of implementing water-saving measures garnered the highest compliance, with a mean score of 4.90. This indicates that the majority of micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad consistently adopt water conservation methods in their daily operations. These may include measures such as checking for leaks, using water-efficient devices, or training staff on mindful water usage. The high level of compliance suggests that this practice is not only feasible for small establishments but also increasingly viewed as standard procedure. The

implementation of water-saving techniques may also be encouraged by external factors such as municipal policies or community campaigns promoting resource conservation.

This result aligns with the Theory of Planned Behavior as outlined by Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020). According to TPB, behavior is more likely to occur when individuals have a positive attitude toward it, perceive social pressure to do it, and believe they can carry it out. In this case, cafe operators may find water-saving practices cost-effective, socially accepted, and within their means, leading to a higher likelihood of adoption. TPB helps explain why this practice ranks highest because it is positively viewed, easily implemented, and supported by the surrounding community.

With a mean of 4.68, proper waste segregation is also among the most consistently followed practices. Many cafes separate their waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable categories, reflecting both compliance with environmental laws and active participation in community-led efforts such as barangay waste management programs. The relatively high compliance with this practice may stem from its simplicity, visibility, and alignment with public expectations and regulations. It also allows business owners to contribute directly to sustainability in a visible and routine manner.

This finding can be interpreted through the Value-Belief-Norm Theory as described by Jebarajakirthy (2024). This theory suggests that individuals who value the environment and believe their actions can positively impact and feel a moral obligation to act accordingly. In this context, cafe owners and staff may see waste segregation not just as a regulation, but as a responsibility. Their internal motivation to protect the environment, combined with societal encouragement, explains the

strong compliance with this practice.

The use of biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and delivery services also ranked high, with a mean of 4.60. This suggests that many cafes in La Trinidad have shifted away from plastic containers in favor of more sustainable options. The consistent implementation of this practice may be influenced by consumer preferences, environmental awareness campaigns, and the increasing availability of biodegradable packaging in the local market.

The Value-Belief-Norm Theory by Jebarajakirthy (2024) supports this behavior, as the decision to use eco-friendly packaging likely stems from internal values and a sense of environmental responsibility. Cafe operators may perceive this practice as an ethical obligation aligned with their belief that businesses should minimize their ecological footprint. The packaging choice becomes more than a business decision by reflecting their environmental values and personal norms.

In contrast, the top three practices with the lowest levels of compliance among micro-scale hospitality businesses in La Trinidad were promoting paperless transactions such as digital receipts or QR code menus (mean score of 3.53), use of energy-efficient appliances (mean score of 3.80), and following policies regarding green practices (mean score of 4.05).

Paperless transactions, such as digital receipts and QR code menus, had the lowest mean score of 3.53, indicating limited implementation across the businesses surveyed. This low compliance may be due to the technological and financial barriers faced by micro-scale cafes, including a lack of access to devices or the internet, low customer familiarity with digital tools, and insufficient training for business owners.

This result is supported by the Resource-Based View Theory by Barney (2021).

According to RBV, an organization's capacity to adopt new practices depends on the resources it possesses. For small businesses, limited access to digital tools and IT infrastructure prevents them from implementing paperless systems. Despite understanding the environmental benefits, the absence of resources and support limits their capacity to act.

The use of energy-efficient appliances, such as LED lighting or inverter air conditioners, received a moderate mean score of 3.80. While some cafes have made efforts to switch to more sustainable technology, many still rely on older, less efficient equipment. This suggests that although the benefits of energy-efficient devices are known, financial concerns and lack of technical support may delay their adoption.

This outcome can also be explained by the Resource-Based View Theory by Barney (2021). The initial investment needed for energy-efficient appliances can be substantial, and small hospitality businesses often lack the capital or access to subsidies to afford these upgrades. Although these technologies offer long-term savings, the short-term financial burden becomes a deterrent which highlights the RBV principle that resource limitations hinder strategic implementation.

The following policies regarding green practices showed a moderate compliance level, with a mean of 4.05. While some businesses strive to follow environmental guidelines, others may not fully understand them or find them difficult to implement consistently. This could be due to limited training, lack of clear regulatory communication, or inconsistent enforcement.

This behavior is best understood through the Theory of Planned Behavior by Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020). Even if business owners and staff have favorable attitudes toward sustainability, they may lack the confidence or understanding

needed to fully implement policy guidelines. If policies are seen as difficult to interpret or beyond their capabilities, perceived behavioral control decreases, leading to lower or inconsistent compliance.

Table 4. Correlation between the Level of Awareness and Level of Compliance on Green Practices among Micro-scale Cafe Industries

Awareness and Compliance	Spearman's rho	df	p-value
	0.256 ^{ns}	38	0.111
not significant			

The correlation analysis between the level of awareness and level of compliance with green practices among micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad yielded a Spearman's rho value of 0.256 and a p-value of 0.111. Since the p-value is greater than the standard significance level of 0.05, this result is not statistically significant, indicating that there is no strong or meaningful relationship between awareness and compliance. This suggests that although many cafe owners and staff may be knowledgeable about environmental practices, that knowledge does not consistently translate into actual implementation. In other words, being aware of sustainability strategies does not guarantee that these practices are applied in daily operations. This finding points to the presence of other underlying factors such as resources, motivation, or structural barriers that might influence whether green practices are adopted or sustained.

This result is consistent with the Theory of Planned Behavior, which emphasizes that awareness or intention alone is insufficient for behavior to occur. According to Yarimoglu and Gunay (2020), actual behavior is influenced by perceived behavioral control, or how easy or difficult people believe it is to perform

the behavior. In this case, even if cafe operators are aware of eco-friendly practices, they may not comply if they believe they lack the resources, time, or external support to do so. TPB helps explain the gap between awareness and action: a person may intend to act sustainably but fail to follow through due to low confidence, lack of stakeholder support, or perceived operational barriers. Thus, this theory clarifies why awareness alone is not a strong predictor of compliance in the context of small hospitality businesses.

The absence of a significant correlation can also be explained by the Resource-Based View Theory proposed by Barney (2021), which argues that the ability to implement strategies like sustainability depends on the resources a business has. Many micro-scale establishments may be well-informed about green practices but lack the financial, technological, or human resources to carry them out. Awareness without access to capital, training, or equipment makes it difficult to turn knowledge into action. The RBV theory therefore supports the idea that resource constraints act as a barrier, weakening the link between knowing what to do and actually doing it.

CHAPTER 4

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter presents the conclusion and recommendations of the study.

Conclusions

The findings of the study resulted in the following conclusions:

1. Most cafe staff in La Trinidad demonstrate a high level of awareness regarding green practices, particularly in water conservation, alternative packaging materials, cost-saving and efficiency in cafe settings, and proper waste management.
2. Green practices are actively implemented, such as waste segregation, water-saving measures, eco-friendly cleaning products, and the use of biodegradable or recyclable packaging.
3. Respondents showed that they are very compliant with the green practices such as water-saving measures, waste segregation, and use of biodegradable or recyclable packaging.
4. There is no significant relationship between awareness and compliance on green practices among micro-scale hospitality industries in La Trinidad based on this data.

Recommendations

In light of the findings and conclusions, the following recommendations were drawn:

1. Local government units (LGU's), together with DENR-CAR and local environmental NGOs, must strengthen efforts to promote specific green practices among cafe staff in La Trinidad.

2. It is recommended that local government and relevant environmental agencies provide more support to cafe operators receive more support in carrying out green practices that are not yet widely implemented, including paperless transactions, the use of grease traps, and energy-efficient lighting or equipment.
3. It is recommended that the local government and environmental organizations continue to recognize and encourage cafes that are highly compliant with green practices such as water-saving measures, waste segregation, and the use of biodegradable or recyclable packaging, incentives, certifications, or public recognition may be provided to sustain and further improve their environmental efforts.
4. It is recommended that cafe owners together with environmental organizations encourage participatory approaches involving customers, such as incentive-based programs for bringing reusable containers, offering discounts for paperless or eco-friendly transactions, providing suggestion boxes or feedback forms on green initiatives, and engaging customers through awareness campaigns or green themed events. Their involvement can make programs more relevant, sustainable, and effective.

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APPENDICES

Consent Form

 **KING'S COLLEGE OF THE PHILIPPINES**
LOVE GOD, LEAD THE NATION, LIGHT THE WORLD
LA TRINIDAD, BENGUET 2601 KCP.EDU.PH KINGSCOLLEGE@KCP.EDU.PH 074-620-3208

FEBRUARY 19, 2025

HON. ROMEO K. SALDA
Municipal Mayor
La Trinidad, Benguet

 MAYOR'S OFFICE
RECEIVED
FEB 19 2025
Control #
La Trinidad, Benguet

Sir,

Greetings of peace and good health!

We, the Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management students of King's College of the Philippines are currently conducting a research study titled "Green Practices in Hospitality Industry at La Trinidad, Benguet. In this regard, may we request of the Lists of registered Cafés in La Trinidad for year 2024-2025 to establish our research study.

This study is only possible with the help and support of your good office. Rest assured that all information gathered shall be for academic purpose only and shall be treated with outmost confidentiality.

Rest assured that all of your information will be kept confidential under the Republic Act No. 10173, otherwise known as the Data Privacy Act.

Your favorable response to this matter will be very much appreciated. God bless and more power!

Respectfully yours,

MERLIN I. BUY-OS
MARC CHRISTIAN D. BAYAS
LINLIN P. CUBEBE
MEURYLLE KATE E. ORDEN
JUSTINE ANGELA B. VILORIA
KENT ANTHONY G. SIBAYAN

Noted:


DOLSEY WRETH P. SAPI
Instructor

Letter to the Respondents



Republic of the Philippines
Province of Benguet
MUNICIPALITY OF LA TRINIDAD
OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL MAYOR
La Trinidad Municipal Hall, Km. 5, La Trinidad, Benguet 2601
Tel. No.: (074) 422-2601 / 422-5618 | Fax No.: (074) 422-5621
Official Website: www.la Trinidad.gov.ph | Email Address: mayors@latriinidad.gov.ph

PERMIT

NO. 51-2025

(CONDUCT STUDY/SURVEY)

PERMIT IS HEREBY GRANTED to the following **3RD YEAR BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN HOSPITALITY MANAGEMENT** students at King's College of the Philippines to conduct data gathering activities in connection with their study on "Green Practices in Hospitality Industry at La Trinidad, Benguet" in partial fulfillment of the requirements of their subject HM 124-1: Research in Hospitality :

- a. MERLIN I. BUY-OS
- b. MARC CHRISTIAN D. BAYAS
- c. LINLIN P. CUBEBE
- d. MEURYLLE KATE E. ORDEN
- e. JUSTINE ANGELA B. VILORIA
- f. KENT ANTHONY G. SIBAYAN

They may distribute questionnaires, conduct interviews and gather data from individuals, barangays, establishments and offices in La Trinidad, Benguet provided these shall be used for the above stated purpose only. Information gathered shall be considered confidential. A copy of the study/research shall be provided the municipality through the Office of the Municipal Mayor.

They are further directed to observe minimum public health standards while conducting their activity.

Issued this 19th day of February, 2025 at La Trinidad, Benguet Province.

FOR : ROMEO K. SALDA
Municipal Mayor

BY : CLARIANE B. LIW-LIWEN
Private Secretary II

NOT VALID WITHOUT OFFICIAL SEAL

O.R.# : 8991507
Paid on : February 19, 2025
Paid at : La Trinidad, Benguet
Amount Paid : Php 50.00



Survey Questionnaire

Name of cafe: _____

Part I: Level of Awareness of Cafes as to Green Practices

Instruction: Please indicate your response by putting a check (✓) on the number that best represents your awareness level based on the scale below:

1 = Not Aware at All (knowledge of this practice).

2 = Slightly Aware (heard of this practice but do not fully understand it).

3 = Somewhat Aware (some understanding of this practice but lack detailed knowledge.)

4 = Aware (good understanding of this practice and its importance.)

5 = Very Aware (extensive knowledge of this practice and its benefits.)

No.	Questions	5	4	3	2	1
1	Aware of green sustainable practices in the hospitality industry.					
2	Aware of the environmental impact of non-sustainable practices in hospitality industry.					
3	Aware of energy-saving practices, such as using LED lights and energy-efficient appliances.					
4	Aware of water conservation methods, such as using low-flow faucets and reusing water when possible.					
5	Aware of proper waste management practices, including recycling and composting.					
6	Aware of the importance of reducing single-use plastics in hospitality industry operations..					
7	Aware of eco-friendly purchasing practices, such as sourcing from sustainable suppliers.					
8	Aware of alternative packaging materials that are biodegradable or recyclable.					
9	Aware of government regulations and policies regarding sustainable hospitality practices.					
10	Aware of how green practices contribute to cost savings and efficiency in a cafe setting.					

Part II: Green Practices Implemented in Cafes

Instruction: Please check (✓) the green practices that your cafe currently implements.

✓	Questions
	1. We use LED lights and energy-efficient appliances to reduce electricity consumption.
	2. We implement water-saving measures, such as low-flow faucets and water reuse systems.
	3. We properly segregate waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable materials.
	4. We have a recycling program for plastic, paper, glass, or other reusable materials.
	5. We minimize the use of single-use plastics by offering reusable or biodegradable alternatives.
	6. We use biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and deliveries.
	7. We promote paperless transactions by using digital receipts or QR code menus.
	8. We use eco-friendly cleaning products that are non-toxic and biodegradable.
	9. We follow policies regarding green practices.
	10. We have installed a grease trap before operating the business.

Part III: Level of Compliance of Cafes as to Green Practices

Instruction: Please indicate your response by putting a check (✓) on the number that best represents your cafe's compliance based on the scale below:

- 1 = Not Compliant at All (not followed in our cafe.)
 2 = Slightly Compliant (followed in a limited or inconsistent manner.)
 3 = Somewhat Compliant (sometimes followed but not fully implemented).
 4 = Compliant (actively followed and implemented in our cafe.)
 5 = Very Compliant (strictly followed at all times in our cafe.)

No.	Questions	5	4	3	2	1
1	We use LED lighting on energy-efficient appliances.					
2	We implement water-saving measures, such as low-flow faucets and water reuse systems.					
3	We properly segregate waste into biodegradable, non-biodegradable, and recyclable materials.					
4	We have a recycling program for					

	plastic, paper, glass, or other reusable materials.					
5	We minimize the use of single-use plastics by offering reusable or biodegradable alternatives.					
6	We use biodegradable or recyclable packaging for takeout and deliveries.					
7	We promote paperless transactions by using digital receipts or QR code menus.					
8	We have a recycling program for plastics,paper,glass,or other reusable materials.					
9	We follow policies regarding the green practices.					
10	We have installed a grease trap before operating the business.					

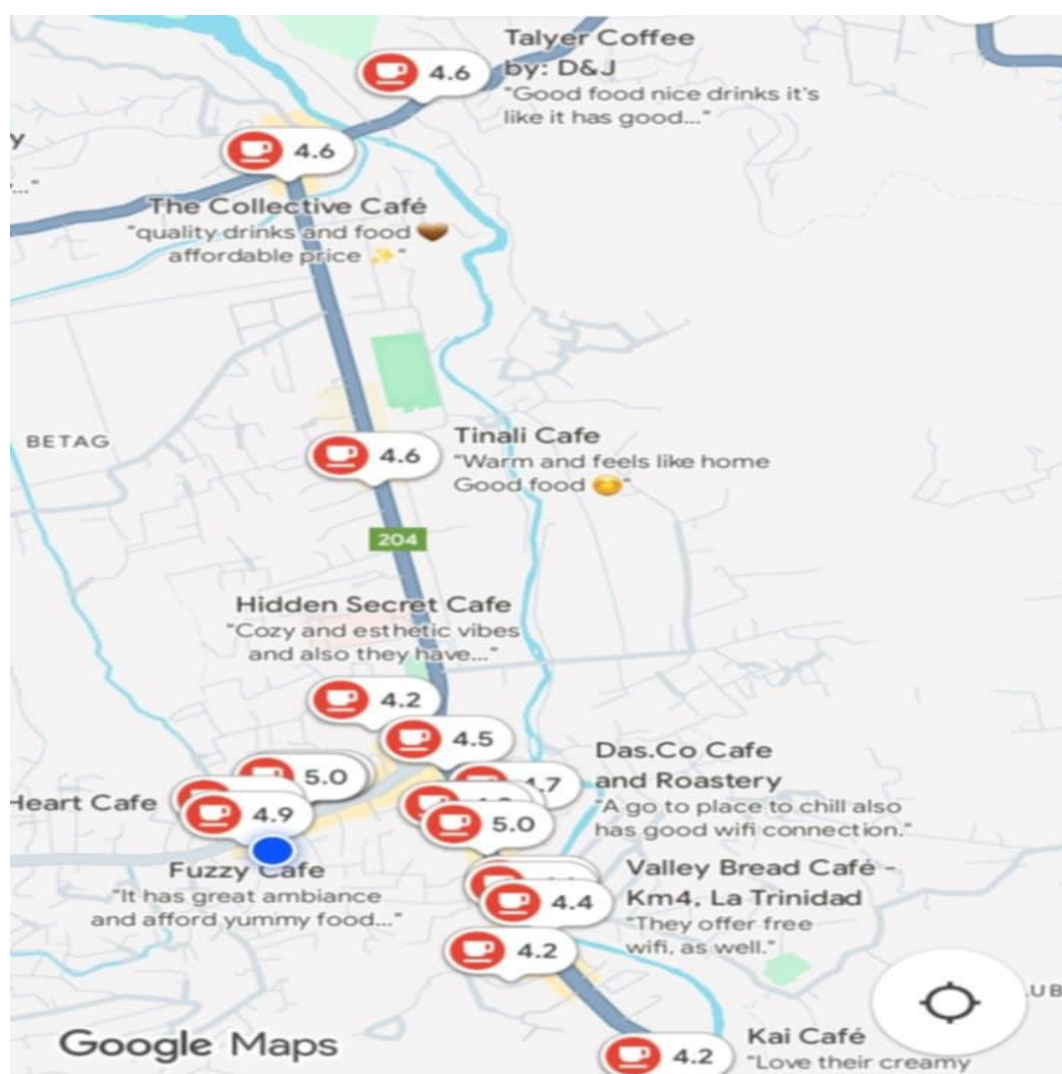
Reliability of Survey Questionnaire

Variables	Chronbach's Alph	Sample size	interpretation
A) Level of awareness	0.870	14	Very Reliable
B) Level of Compliance	0.951	14	Highly Reliable

Legend:

Reliability Coefficient	Credibility
Reliability <.30	Not Reliable
0.30 - 0.40	Barely Reliable
0.41 - 0.50	Slightly Reliable
0.51 - 0.70	Reliable
0.70 - 0.90	Very Reliable
0.90 < reliability	Highly Reliable

Location Map of Central Cafes in La Trinidad



CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: Kent Anthony G. Sibayan

Address: Apolog Street, Balbalayang (Poblacion), Sugpon, Ilocos Sur

Personal Information:

Date of Birth: August 23, 2003
 Place of Birth: Sugpon Rural Health Center, Sugpon, Ilocos Sur
 Citizenship: Filipino
 Civil status: Single
 Provincial Address: Sugpon, Ilocos Sur

Education:

Tertiary Level: King's College of The Philippines
 Pico Rd. La Trinidad, Benguet
 Secondary Level: King's College of The Philippines
 Pico Rd. La Trinidad, Benguet
 Elementary: Sugpon Central School
 Sugpon, Ilocos Sur

AWARDS RECEIVED:

U.S.A.P.E.E.C All hands-on Duck Competition

SEMINARS ATTENDED:

Seminars And Familiarization
 Le Monet - Camp John Hay, Baguio City
 May 12- 13, 2023
 Basic First Aid and Training
 Kings College of the Philippines - Pico, La Trinidad Benguet
 October 07, 2022
 Food Handlers Orientation Seminar
 Kings College of the Philippines - Pico, La Trinidad Benguet
 October 20, 2022

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: Merlin I.Buy-os

Address: #85 K Purok 9 Pinsao Proper, Baguio City

PERSONAL INFORMATION:

Date of Birth: MAY 28,2003

Place of Birth: Baguio City

Citizenship: Filipino

Civil Status: Single

Provincial Address: Sadanga, Mt. Province

EDUCATION:

Tertiary Level: King's College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad Benguet

Secondary Level: Guisad Valley National High School
Bado,Dangwa St, Cresencia Village,
Baguio City

Elementary: Bonifacio Elementary School
Bado,Dangwa St, Cresencia Village,
Baguio City

SEMINARS ATTENDED:

Basic First Aid Training
Kings College of the Philippines- Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet
October 7, 2022

Basic Food Handlers
Kings College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet
October 20, 2022

Hotel Familiarization
Le Monet Hotel
Camp John Hay. Baguio City
May 12- 13, 2022

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: Linlin P. Cubebe

Address: Aguid, Sagada, Mt. Province

PERSONAL INFORMATION:

Date Of Birth: October 17, 2001
Place Of Birth: Sagada, Mt. Province
Citizenship: Filipino
Civil Status: Single
Provincial Address: Sagada, Mt. Province

EDUCATION:

Tertiary Level: King's College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet
Secondary Level: Sain'T Marys School of Sagada, Inc.
Sagada Mt. Province
Elementary: Aguid Elementary School
Sagada Mt. Province

AWARDS RECEIVED:

Bronze Awardee (Pasta Sauce Showdown)

SEMINARS ATTENDED:

Basic First Aid Training
Kings College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad. Benguet
October 7, 2022

Hotel Familiarization
Le Monet Hotel
Camp John Hay, Baguio City
May 12-13, 2023

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: Meurylle Kate E. Orden

Address: JB25-5 Km4,Pico,La Trinidad,Benguet

PERSONAL INFORMATION:

Date Of Birth: November 8, 2003

Place Of Birth: Baggao,Cagayan Valley

Citizenship: Filipino

Civil Status: Single

Provincial Address: Caliking Proper,Caliking,
Atok,Benguet

EDUCATION:

Tertiary Level: King's College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet

Secondary Level: Guisad Valley National High School
Bado,Dangwa St, Cresencia Village, Baguio City

Elementary: Caliking Elementary School
Atok, Benguet

SEMINARS ATTENDED:

Basic Food Handlers
Kings College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet
October 20, 2022

Hotel Familiarization
Le Monet Hotel
Camp John Hay, Baguio City
May 12-13, 2023

CURRICULUM VITAE

NAME: Justine Angela B.Viloria

Address: PA017 B Wangal, La Trinidad, Benguet

Personal Information:

Date Of Birth: June 2, 2004

Place Of Birth: La Trinidad, Benguet

Citizenship: Filipino

Civil Status: Single

Provincial Address: Salinas, Purok West, Bambang, Nueva Vizcaya

EDUCATION:

Tertiary Level: King's College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet

Secondary Level: Cordillera Career Development
College
Poblacion, La Trinidad, Benguet

Elementary: Cordillera Career Development
College
Poblacion, La Trinidad, Benguet

SEMINARS ATTENDED:

Basic Food Handlers
Kings College of the Philippines
Pico, La Trinidad, Benguet
October 20, 2022

Hotel Familiarization
Le Monet Hotel
Camp John Hay, Baguio City
May 12-13, 2023